

along — Sprint 4: Expenses (Equal Split)

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Split out from the along — Sprint Epics, User Stories & Journey Maps document for standalone sprint planning.

Goal: any member can log an expense in seconds and split it equally among the right people — the core loop the whole product depends on.

User stories

ID	Story	Acceptance
4.1 (US-05)	As a member, I want to add an expense I paid	Amount/title saved → attributed to me as payer and added-by by default
4.2 (US-06)	As a member, I want to record an expense paid by someone else	Selected payer is recorded as payer, me as added-by
4.3 (US-07)	As a member, I want to split an expense among only selected participants	Only the selected subset receives a liability
4.4	As a member, I want the split to default to equal among selected people	Equal split auto-calculates per-person amounts as I add/remove participants
4.5	As a member, I want to see my running balance change after I log an expense	Balance view reflects the new expense immediately

Success criteria

- Median time to log an expense $\leq$ 20 seconds from tapping "Add Expense."
- $\geq$ 50% of trips have expenses added by more than one member (expense collaboration, PRD north star input).
- Zero expenses saved with a split that doesn't sum to the total (enforced server-side, verified in tests).
- No duplicate expenses from double-tap submission (idempotency key verified).

User flow

1. Trip → Expenses → Add Expense.
2. Enter amount and title → payer defaults to me (changeable) → select participants (defaults to all, editable).
3. Equal split calculates live → Save.
4. Expense appears in the list; Balances updates immediately.

Journey map

Stage	User does	User feels	System response	Opportunity
Spend	Pays for lunch, wants to log it before forgetting	Wants this to take seconds, not a form	Amount + title + Save is the whole flow	Keep the default path to 3 taps or fewer
Attribute	Realizes a friend actually paid, not them	Slight friction changing the payer	Payer field is a simple picker	Make "who paid" as fast to change as "how much"
Check in	Opens Balances later to see where things stand	Curious, wants reassurance nothing's off	Balance reflects the new expense instantly	Real-time updates remove any doubt the app "saw" the expense